

Buddy Walk

User Testing Guide

Accessibility-first navigation for blind & low-vision travelers

What We're Testing

- Buddy Walk combines **camera + voice Q&A, spoken answers**, and **hands-off turn-by-turn guidance** (haptics on native iOS).
- This round focuses on **real-world usability** — especially by ear and touch, with VoiceOver where possible.
- Auth is **bypassed** for this beta: after permissions, you land on the main screen. No sign-in required.

How to Access the Beta

- **Web beta (available now)**
 - <https://buddy-walk-mobile.vercel.app>
 - Open in **Safari (iPhone)** or **Chrome** — allow camera, mic, and location when prompted.
- **iOS app (TestFlight)**
 - Install via TestFlight when your build is approved in App Store Connect.
 - Native app = full **haptic navigation** and **shake-to-stop**.
- **Tip:** hard-refresh the web page if you tested an older build (Ctrl+Shift+R / pull-to-refresh).

Before You Start

- Complete the **permissions screen**: location, camera, and microphone — all three are required.
- Use **headphones** or turn volume up so spoken answers are easy to hear.
- For the fairest location test, use a **phone browser** (real GPS), not a desktop on campus Wi-Fi.
- If you hear *"Your location looks approximate"*, nearby results may be off — try again on a phone.

Test 1 — Camera + Voice Q&A

- **Goal:** confirm capture, questions, and spoken answers work end-to-end.
- Point the camera at your surroundings.
 - **Tap quickly** on the camera area → photo captured (you'll hear confirmation).
 - **Hold** the camera area → video mode (web samples frames; native records video).
- Ask a question:
 - Tap **Tap to Ask** and speak, **or** type in the text field.
 - Tap **Submit**.
- **Pass if:** the answer is **accurate, spoken once**, and **easy to hear**.

Test 2 — Hands-Off Navigation

- **Goal:** directions start automatically — no extra buttons.
- Ask: *"How do I get to [a nearby place]?"* (e.g. a café, station, or landmark).
- **Native (TestFlight / Expo Go):**
 - Navigation **starts automatically** — vibrations + spoken turn-by-turn.
 - Steps advance **as you walk** (GPS) or on a timer when GPS points are missing.
 - Near the destination: hear **"You have arrived."**
 - **Shake the phone** to stop → buzz + "Navigation stopped."
- **Web:** voice directions work; **haptics and shake-to-stop are native-only.** Use **Stop Navigation** on screen.

Test 3 — VoiceOver & Accessibility

- **Goal:** the whole flow works with the screen reader on.
- Turn on **VoiceOver** (Settings → Accessibility → VoiceOver).
- Run Tests 1 and 2 again:
 - Buttons and status should be **announced** clearly.
 - Arrival and off-route warnings should use **assertive** announcements.
 - You should **not** hear the same text twice (app TTS + VoiceOver overlapping).
- **Pass if:** you can complete the flow **without seeing the screen**.

Test 4 — Companion Mode

- **Goal:** generate a live location share link for a trusted contact.
- From the main screen, open **Companion Mode**.
- **Pass if:**
 - A **share link** is created successfully.
 - Your contact can open it and see **live location updates** (same Wi-Fi / network as backend).
- Report if the link fails to load or location doesn't update.

Test 5 — Saved Places

- **Goal:** save addresses and use them in natural-language questions.
- Open **Saved Places** and save a location (e.g. alias **home**).
- Return to main and ask: *"How do I get home?"*
- **Pass if:**
 - The app resolves your saved alias.
 - You get **directions** (and auto-navigation on native).

What to Report

- Anything that **doesn't speak or vibrate** when you expect it to.
- **Wrong or vague directions** — especially if GPS seemed fine.
- **Accidental navigation stops** while walking (native shake sensitivity).
- **VoiceOver** issues: missed labels, double speech, unreachable controls.
- **Web-only:** white screen, photo errors, bad location on desktop.
- Include: device (iPhone model / browser), what you asked, and what happened.

Quick Reference

- **Web beta:**
 - <https://buddy-walk-mobile.vercel.app>
- **Camera:** tap = photo, hold = video
- **Directions:** ask naturally → navigation auto-starts (native)
- **Stop navigation:** shake phone (native) or Stop button (web)
- **Feedback email:** raymondsekyere123@icloud.com

Thank You

- Your feedback directly shapes Buddy Walk for blind and low-vision travelers.
- Try the beta: <https://buddy-walk-mobile.vercel.app>
- Questions & discussion.